

SAYS PILOT COHEN OF 19-6 RECORD

Pitching, Desire Put Denver on Top

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By BOB BEEBE

Minneapolis Star Staff Writer
Pitching and desire. Those are the factors, according to Manager Andy Cohen, that have sent Denver's Bears away to a sizzling (19-6) start in the American Association pennant race.

The Bears are 3½ games ahead of second-place Minneapolis as they move in to open a four-game series with the Millers at Metropolitan stadium tonight. Minneapolis lost a chance to gain Thursday when St. Paul's Charlie Ready shut them out 4-0 with two hits.

"We aren't the powerhouse Denver was last year, not with hitters like Norm Siebern and Marv Throneberry gone," Cohen explained. "Our pitching has carried us so far and must be our hope."

"BUT YOU can't discount these kids' desire. Their spirit is great and no one fellow has been the big man. I know this sounds trite but it's been strictly a team effort."

Andy sees little chance of getting Throneberry back from the New York Yankees and has something of a first-base problem. Jim McManus, Kansas City optionee, hasn't had a full test because of a bad leg.

INJURIES also have hampered outfielder Zeke Bella who has shown first-basing aptitude and catcher Johnny Blanchard has had a shot at the gateway, too.

Cohen is high on Blanchard both as a catcher and hitter and says "I'm counting on old George Wilson when the weather warms up."

"Jim Pisoni, our center-fielder," the Bear skipper went on, "has played great ball, furnished much of our punch and Gordon Windhorn has been a pleasant surprise in the outfield."

"Youngsters like Tom Carroll at short and Curt Hardaway at third are doing well. I don't expect shortstop Fritz Brickell to report from the Yankees while we're here but when he does we'll have to make room for him."

Cohen says he will start Ben Flowers (3-1) tonight and Zack Monroe (4-0) Saturday afternoon. Miller manager Gene Mauch will pitch Bert Thiel tonight. Ted Bowsfield Saturday and Dean Stone and Bill Monbouquette Sunday.

WITHOUT THEIR left-handed punch, Faye Throneberry, the Millers were easy victims of the erstwhile St. Paul relief pitcher, Ready, making his first start as a substitute for the recalled Stan Williams.

THE ONLY hits were singles by Pumpsie Green in the first inning and Tom Umphlett in the third. Only four Millers reached first and none got past it as Ready faced only 18 men in the last six innings. He now has allowed only five runs in 24 innings for a 3-1 record.

Tom Borland pitched well for four innings, then lost control and four walks and a hit batsman ruined him in the next two rounds. Lacey Curry doubled home two tallies in the fifth and Dick Gray, just down from the Dodgers, homered in the two-run sixth.

NO HELP YET FOR MILLERS

There are no new developments in the Minneapolis Miller player situation today. General Manager Tommy Thomas was in touch with the Boston Red Sox in an effort to get outfielder Marty Keough as a replacement for the departed Faye Throneberry, but reported no success.

Throneberry, recalled by Washington Thursday morning, flew to join the Senators a few hours later. Meanwhile word also was being awaited from infielder Ray Smalley who was contacted by Manager Gene Mauch after his release by the Phillies.

Grads to Test Untried Varsity

★MINNESOTA'S ANNUAL spring football game always has plenty of spectator appeal, especially since the Alumni began battling the Varsity.

However, interest may be higher than usual Saturday afternoon as Murray Warmath puts the results of his 20 days of practice on display before what should be another big crowd.

After last fall's letdown, the fans are more curious than ever to find out what the Gophers' chances of a comeback in 1958 may be.

There is no question that the Alumni, with their star-studded squad of experienced players, will test the 1958 Varsity to the limit.

Coch Billy Bye has assembled the usual group of outstanding name performers. They may be a little stronger on defense than offense but good enough in both departments to make the kids hustle.

Outside of two positions, Warmath will send lettermen into action with his first team. Freshmen will take over one guard spot and the fullback among the starters. The spectators' curiosity will center around the caliber of reserves the 1958 hopefuls will offer. They are practically all newcomers with little or no Big Ten experience, but boasting plenty of promise.

Warmath has been well satisfied with the limited 20 days of work the boys have had this spring. They have toiled hard and are eager.

It will be recalled that the defense the Alumni set up for the Varsity's split-T in the 1957 game was generally copied by Big Ten foes with good results in the fall.

Such boys as Leo Nomellini, Clayton Tonnemaker, Wayne Robinson, Gordy Holz and Roger French will again be hard to push around by any ball carriers the Gophers put on the field.

Offensively the old grads do not appear to be so formidable although they'll have Bobby Cox, about to start his pro career, finding himself with two fine passing targets in Bud Grant and Gordie Soltau.

Main interest in the Varsity exhibition will center on the quarterback talent. Jim Reese is the No. 1 man at this key spot, but the reserves behind him will get a good once-over.

New fullbacks like Roger Hazberg, Tom Robbins and Jim Rogers will be under fire for the first time.

Come what may the spring finale should measure up in every way as far as this annual attraction goes.

They won't have to hold up the start of Saturday's football game for Leo Nomellini. He arrived plenty early for this one.

What a Week-end!

★THIS IS ONE OF THOSE week-ends for sports lovers when many wish they could be in three or four places at the same time.

For example, tonight marks the first appearance of the talented Denver baseball club in Metropolitan stadium against the Millers in a series winding up with a double header Sunday.

At 12:01 a.m. tonight, the more hardy fishermen will be attacking the walleyes all over the state with thousands continuing the pursuit of the elusive finny through tomorrow and Sunday.

In addition to a day baseball game at Bloomington tomorrow, the Alumni-Varsity football showdown in Memorial stadium will attract thousands.

Tomorrow night the pro tennis stars take over in the Minneapolis auditorium. The Lew Hoad-Pancho Gonzales headline could be one of the more entertaining exhibitions by the pros.

It's well to keep in mind in connection with the court event that the sponsors—the Northwestern Tennis Patrons—plow their profits back into development of youngsters in this area.

Millers Are Hard Hit

★USUALLY MINOR LEAGUE baseball managers look forward to the deadline for cutting player talent from the majors' rosters.

Not so in Minneapolis. This club, still in second place, got a terrific sock on May 15.

Not only did the Millers fail to get any help that amounts to anything from the Boston Red Sox but their puncheon roster lost its only dependable hitter in Faye Throneberry, one of the two left-handed swingers on the club.

His loss was a terrific blow because Throneberry departed at a time when Gene Mauch's regulars are having a terrible time putting any runs together.

HOW THE MILLERS suffered was most apparent Thursday night as the club was blanked by St. Paul. The locals got only two safeties for a most pathetic showing.

In the meantime, every American Association rival but Louisville took on important strength from their cousins in the big show.

St. Paul may have been the biggest gainer even though Brooklyn recalled two of its players—Stan Williams and Bob Wilson. The five sent down in exchange are all good triple A performers who could make pennant contenders out of the Saints.

Charleston, Wichita, Omaha, Denver and Indianapolis also benefited.

Minneapolis not only lost its best punch but there doesn't appear to be any help in the offing from the Red Sox.

Calvin Griffith wasn't fair with the Millers. If he had to have Throneberry why couldn't he have replaced him with one of the two outfielders he disposed of just before the recall?

EX-MILLER PAULA SPIKES SUNDIN SHUTOUT ATTEMPT

By Associated Press
Gordy Sundin held Sacramento to three hits Thursday night as he pitched first-place Vancouver to a 7-1 Pacific Coast league victory over the Solons.

Sacramento spoiled Sundin's shutout by scoring one run in the eighth inning on Carlos Paula's triple, the first hit off Sundin, and a sacrifice fly.

Sundin struck out two batters and walked three in working the full nine innings for the Mounties.

Sundin is a former three-sport star at Washburn high school in Minneapolis. Paula, coincidentally, is a former Minneapolis Miller.



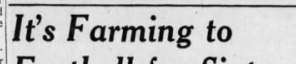
Denver 7th AA

By HALSEY HALL
Minneapolis Star Staff Writer

There's a man in town wearing Denver regalia at the Stadium tonight who doesn't know what the word "stranger" means.

He has been player coach for three American Association teams and managed a fourth. He has played for seven of the league cities—Columbus, Omaha (when it was in the Western league), Minneapolis, Louisville, Charleston, Kansas City (in the AA) and Denver.

He has missed Wichita, Indianapolis and St. Paul. "If I can go 10 more



VERN RAPP
Much traveled

It's Farming to Football for Sixta

By DICK GORDON
Minneapolis Star Staff Writer

In an Alumni-Varsity football game where feelings on both sides may be more spirited than usual, there are other highlights surrounding Saturday's 2 p.m. kickoff at Memorial stadium:

Billy Bye, the grid grads' coach, says: "It's no secret, we're going to pass all over the place." That could really test the Varsity's defense on one of its major weaknesses in 1957.

Norman Sixta, the Varsity tackle, is back after an eight-day emergency on the family farm at Pennock, Minn. Norm's father was injured in a fall from a tractor and his brother suffered a ruptured appendix—so the big Gopher had to drop out of school temporarily to take over the farm chores.

Leo Nomellini, the old pro, is here ahead of time for a change after starting in last year's victorious Alumni defense despite a late arrival.

On the feeling angle there are specific considerations: The grads have several of last year's Gophers in their lineup like Bobby Cox, Frank Youso, Dave Burkholder and Bob Schultz.

They are anxious to show a lot of people they weren't as bad as their 1957 record sometimes indicated.

On the Varsity side the 1957 reserves have taken over as current regulars. Along with the freshmen, they are out to prove the many departed lettermen were not indispensable.

How they fare tomorrow against the Old Guard may be the tipoff on what's to come this fall.

There is plenty of interest in Gopher baseball, too, with Dick Siebert's squad still in title contention and resuming the Iowa series Saturday in a Delta field twin bill at 11 a.m.

The advance football sale of 4,500 has been swelled by purchase of 2,000 seats by "M" club members. The north tower ticket booth opens at 9 a.m. at the Stadium tomorrow with a big gate sale expected.

Get New Challenge

A field of new challengers will be aiming at upsetting the supremacy of Bernie Hentgen, Jim Rehbein and Vern Moga in the seven events of jalopy racing scheduled for 8:30 tonight on the quarter-mile strip of Twin City speedway.



Nomellini Sixta

Gagne to Von Eric

Verne Gagne and Fritz Von Erich will headline Tuesday's wrestling card at the Army in a one-fall, one-hour time limit match.

Gagne, who holds the US TV heavyweight title, signed for the match after he teamed with Leo Nomellini Thursday night to win a three-fall tag team match against the Gallagher brothers, Mike and Doc.

Leo pinned Doc at 11:10 for the first fall. Doc retaliated by knocking out Gagne at 5:31 and then Gagne floored Mike twice with dropkicks to win at 7:20.

In the other headliner, Ilio Di Paola pinned Hard Boiled

TALENT SHOW 12 Horses

BALTIMORE, Md.—(UP)—The 12 horses expected to run in the 82nd Freshness Saturday all were entered today for the middle jewel in racing's triple crown, with Calumet Farm's Tim Tam at the top of the list.

Also named for the mile and three-sixteenths race were the Maine Chance Farm and three-time winner of the entry of Jewel's Reward and Liberty Ruler; Lincoln Road, Nourdin, Silky Sullivan,